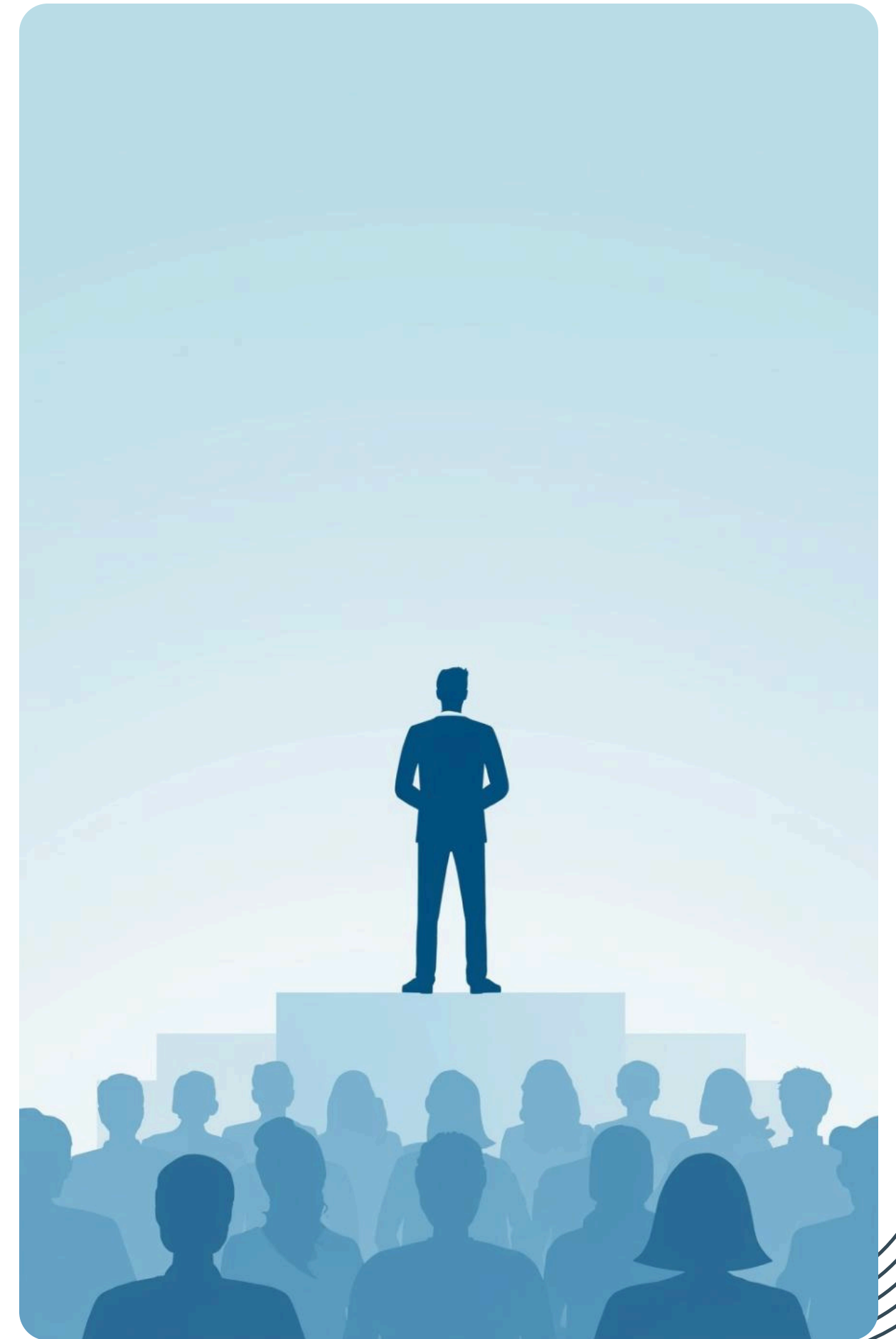


Speaking Up, Whistleblowing, and Moral Courage



Why Speaking up is Hard

- Fear of retaliation
- Social isolation
- Career consequences
- Financial risk
- Loyalty conflicts

Most professionals stay silent not because they are unethical but because the cost feels too high.



Internal vs External Whistleblowing

Internal

- Raise issue to manager
- Ethics hotline
- Compliance office
- Legal department

Preferred first step.



Internal vs External Whistleblowing

External

- Regulatory bodies
- Media
- Public disclosure

Higher risk, but sometimes necessary.

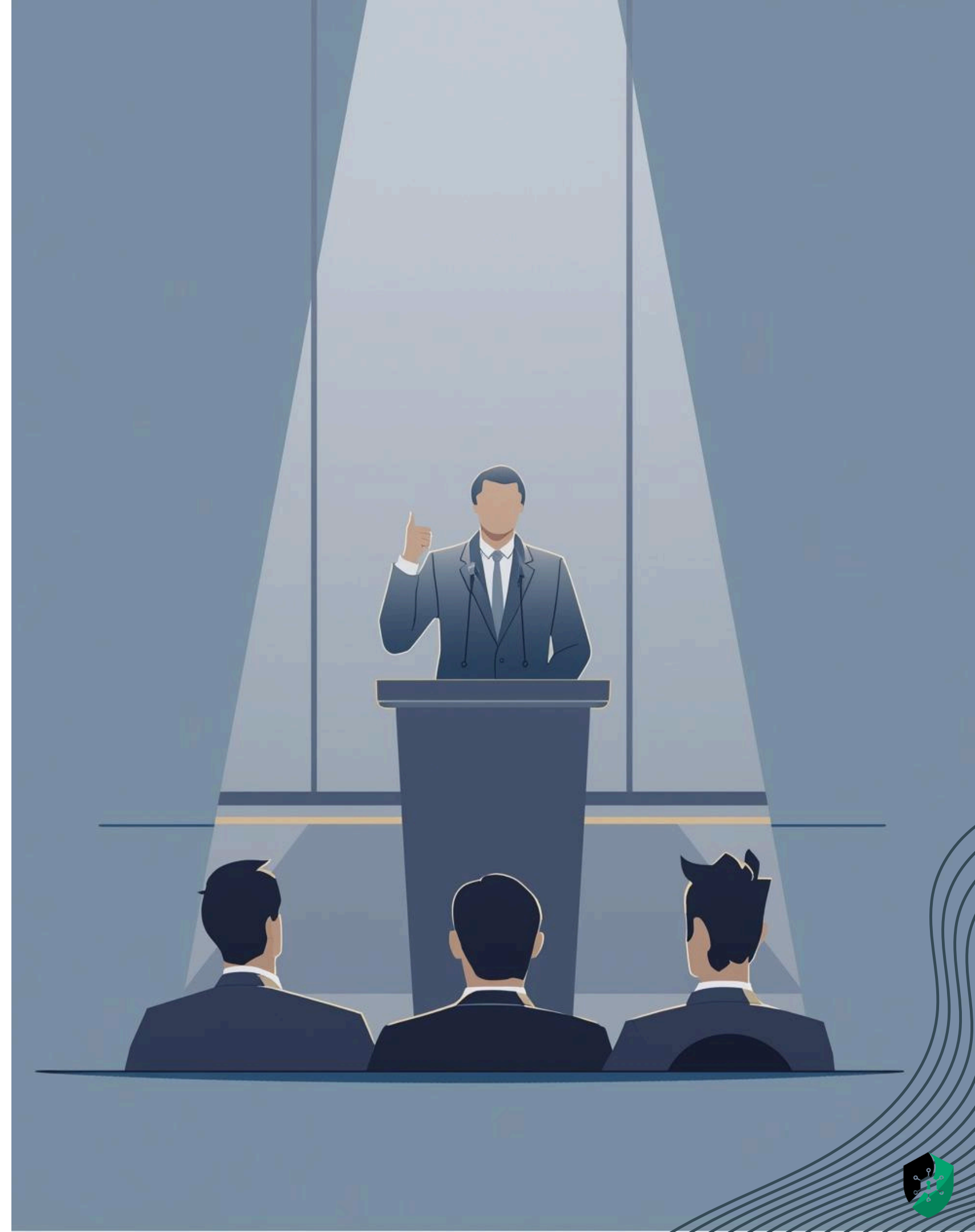


Moral Courage

Moral courage involves:

- Acting despite risk
- Protecting vulnerable stakeholders
- Prioritizing long-term integrity over short-term safety

But it must be strategic, not reckless.



Practical Guidance

Before escalating:

- Gather evidence.
- Consult confidential legal advice.
- Understand whistleblower protections.
- Protect your documentation.

Be realistic not idealistic.

